

Algebra 1 Readiness Worksheet

Try these six sample tasks before Algebra 1. Ask your child to show their reasoning. Mark each area: Independent / With help / Revisit. Parent review notes are on page 2.

Child: _____ Date: _____

1. Operations with negatives Compute $-5 - 3$ and $(-4) \times (-2)$. Explain how you chose each sign.

Independent / With help / Revisit

2. Fractions, decimals, and percentages Compute $\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{4}$. Write $\frac{3}{4}$ as a decimal and a percentage. Explain why the denominators matter.

Independent / With help / Revisit

3. Order of operations Evaluate $3 + 2 \times (5 - 1)$. Which operation happens first, and why?

Independent / With help / Revisit

4. Number sense and properties Show two ways to calculate $3 \times (4 + 2)$. Explain why both give the same result.

Independent / With help / Revisit

5. Variables and equations Solve $x + 5 = 12$. What does x stand for, and how can you check the answer?

Independent / With help / Revisit

6. Logical reasoning Three identical notebooks and a \$2 pen cost \$14 altogether. What does one notebook cost? Write a plan or equation.

Independent / With help / Revisit

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Parent review notes. Ask for reasoning before showing these answers. A single sample task is a starting point for a conversation about each skill area.

1. Operations with negatives

$-5 - 3 = -8$; $(-4) \times (-2) = 8$. Look for a coherent explanation of subtraction and the product of two negatives.

2. Fractions, decimals, and percentages

$\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{4} = \frac{3}{4}$; $\frac{3}{4} = 0.75 = 75\%$. A half is two quarters, so adding one quarter gives three equal quarter-sized pieces.

3. Order of operations

11. First evaluate the parentheses: $5 - 1 = 4$. Then multiply: $2 \times 4 = 8$. Finally add 3.

4. Number sense and properties

18. Either compute 3×6 , or distribute: $(3 \times 4) + (3 \times 2) = 12 + 6$. A drawing of three groups can show why.

5. Variables and equations

$x = 7$. Subtract 5 from both sides to preserve equality. Check: $7 + 5 = 12$.

6. Logical reasoning

\$4 per notebook. Subtract the \$2 pen from \$14, then divide \$12 among three notebooks. An equation is $3n + 2 = 14$.

Area to revisit / explanation or example that was difficult:

One practice activity / person to ask / review date:

Use additional examples to explore fractions, exponents, division, and other prerequisite skills mentioned in the article. Discuss recurring gaps with your child's teacher or at ritetutor.com/contact.